



Vikram rockets to be launched

Hyderabad based startup Skyroot Aerospace is gearing up to launch rockets
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Funding for tier 2 startups

Investors are finally starting to fund startups in smaller cities and towns in India.
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Supercharged

India's startups are driving the electric vehicle ecosystem in all possible ways

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lectric vehicle sales are growing at an unprecedented pace around the world. In some markets, EVs

have almost overtaken combustion engine vehicles. A number of factors are driving this, including dropping battery costs, increasing energy efficiency and a greater awareness about the improving cost-benefit ratio of investing in electric vehicles, but most importantly, the urgent need to tackle rising air pollu-

tion, particularly in countries like India. Studies have concluded that out of the top 30 most air-polluted cities in the world, India has 22.

To tackle this pressing problem, the government and companies in India are doing a lot to push electric vehicles. According to reports, the Government of India wants to convert all bus transport to electric buses to combat air pollution in the country. A major part of the EV revolution in the country is being driven by startups. From developing vehicles with India-specific requirements in mind, to developing the requisite infrastructure to support an EV ecosystem - startups are approaching this systematically and could be exactly what India needs to fulfill its EV dream. To understand how, let's take a look at how different aspects of the ecosystem are being tackled by startups.

VEHICLES

The area that is seeing the most action is the development of actual electric vehicles. One of the most prominent names in the segment is Ather Energy. Founded in 2013, the startup focuses on developing smart electric scooters. Along with being an electric vehicle, these scooters come with a host of smart features like a dashboard providing driving insights and more. The Ather bike goes 75 km on a single charge, but some users say they have managed 100 km. The total time to charge is four hours; 80 percent of the battery charges in two hours. They plan to install 200 new EV charging stations and also launch in four cities beyond Bengaluru in 2019 - Chennai, Pune, Hyderabad and Mumbai.

22motors is another startup making its presence felt in this segment. Founded in 2016, their flagship prod-